

English 5480: American Poetry and the “Little Magazines”

Final Exam, Fall 2008

Before you begin, read through the entire exam. Choose a combination of questions that demonstrates the breadth as well as the depth of your knowledge. Generally you should not discuss the same author in depth in more than one essay. Read each question carefully, answer all parts of the question, organize your essay into coherent paragraphs, and support your answer with specific examples. Refer to secondary sources when appropriate.

Take about 20% of the allotted time to plan each essay before you begin writing. The exam lasts from 6:00-8:00 p.m. Budget your time. Allow time to print your exam within the allotted time.

Choose *two* of the following. Each essay is worth 50% and should take about an hour.

1. Choose *two* of the following—Pound, Eliot, Williams, Moore—and make a case for their importance and influence as *editors* of modernism. Draw comparisons where appropriate.
2. Analyze and compare the editorial agendas of *two* magazines we have studied. You may consider, if applicable, manifestos and editorials published in each magazine as well as the authors and/or genres of literature published therein. Be sure to include how the bibliographic code contributes to the agenda.
3. Explain the concept of the bibliographic code, and make a case for its importance in understanding modernist poetry. Use specific examples from the poets and magazines we have studied in making your case.
4. Trace the early poetic career (up to and including the 1920s) of any one of the American poets we have studied and, referring to specific poems, make a case for the importance of particular editors and magazines in shaping that poet’s career and reputation.